



## **INFORMED CONSENT STATEMENT/INFORMATION LETTER**

### **A Study in Decision Making**

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You are invited to participate in a research study aimed at understanding decision-making in work settings. The study is being conducted by Dr. Christopher Castille (Associate Professor of Management, Primary Investigator), Dr. Ann-Marie R. Castille (Associate Professor of Management, Co-Investigator), Dr. Samantha Falgout (Assistant Professor of Accounting, Co-Investigator), Dr. Kaitlin Gravois (Instructor of Management / MBA, Co-Investigator), and Dr. Adrien Maught (Instructor / Student Researcher, Co-Investigator) from Nicholls State University. This study is part of a larger, multi-site research project.

#### **Information**

You are invited to participate because you hold a Nicholls State University SONA Research account. If you agree to participate in this study, you will work on a decision-making task involving word problems. The purpose of this task is to help us understand how people approach word problems. You will also be asked to complete some measures about the task as well as a basic personality trait measure and demographics. Participation in this study will take no more than 1 hour to complete.

#### **Risks**

There are no known or anticipated risks associated with participation in this study.

#### **Benefits**

The researchers cannot guarantee any direct benefits from participation. However, an important contribution of scientific research into organizational behavior is to provide organizations, managers, and employees with data so they can better understand how business and social practices influence employee behavior. In this study, you will be helping us understand the factors that determine employees' decision making and how managers can influence employees' behavior.

#### **Confidentiality of Your Information**

Approximately 200 students from Nicholls State University will be invited to complete this study. All data collected will be anonymous. Please do not put any identifying information (e.g., name) on your materials. Any information that

could potentially identify participants will be immediately removed from the data. No information that would potentially identify a participant will be used in the analyses and/or results. Furthermore, because the interest of this study is in the average responses of the entire group of participants, you will not be identified individually in any way in any written reports of this research.

Any raw data will be kept for a period of at least 5 to 7 years per APA guidelines following publication of the research. The data will be stored securely on password-protected servers maintained by Nicholls State University and in secure digital locations. Only the researchers affiliated with Nicholls State University who are listed at the top of this form will have access to the raw data.

Anonymized data related to your participation will be shared with our collaborators at other universities. It will also be stored on the Open Science Framework (OSF), which is an online platform for data storage and management. The OSF is a secure and reputable platform widely used for research data storage and sharing, ensuring compliance with data protection and privacy standards. The data will also be submitted to a journal (i.e., the data may be publicly available). The data will be completely anonymized prior to submission and will be presented in aggregate form in publications. This process is integral to the research process as it allows other researchers to verify results and avoid duplicating research. Though the data is posted for the purpose listed, other individuals may access these data by accessing the open access repository. Although the dataset without identifiers may be shared publicly, your identity will always remain confidential. Should you not wish to submit your data in this manner, please do not select this study.

#### Remuneration

For participating in this study, you will receive up to \$14.00 cash reward (with a minimum of \$10.00 cash for most conditions, or \$7.00 base + \$1.00 per round met for the reward condition) during the study.

#### Contact

This study has been reviewed and received ethics clearance through the Human Subjects Institutional Review Board (HSIRB) at Nicholls State University (Protocol: IRB 2024-07-30-001 CBA). If you have questions for the Board, contact the HSIRB Chairperson or college representative at Nicholls State University.

For all other questions, after receiving this letter, or if you would like additional information to assist you in reaching a decision about participation, please feel free to ask the student investigator or a faculty supervisor listed at the top of this sheet.

#### Participation

Your participation in this study is voluntary. You may decide to withdraw from this study at any time by advising the researcher and may do so without loss of your remuneration. If you withdraw from the study before data collection is completed, you will receive your remuneration, but your data will be destroyed. You have the right to skip any question(s)/procedure(s) you choose.

Once you have completed the study, you can no longer withdraw your data, as the data will not be identifiable.

#### Feedback and Publication

The results of the study may be submitted to peer-reviewed academic journals for publication consideration and/or be presented at a conference. If you would like a copy of the results, please contact the research team at [kaitlin.gravois@nicholls.edu](mailto:kaitlin.gravois@nicholls.edu) or [christopher.castille@nicholls.edu](mailto:christopher.castille@nicholls.edu).

#### CONSENT

By signing this consent form, you are not waiving your legal rights or releasing the investigator(s) or involved institution(s) from their legal and professional responsibilities.

By signing this form, you agree that you have had the opportunity to ask any questions and receive satisfactory answers.

I agree to participate in this study.

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Name of Participant

Signature of Participant

Date

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